

Board: 2

Dealer: **North**

Contract: 3NT

Declarer: North

Board: 4

Dealer: **East**

Contract: 4♥

Declarer: East

Board 2

North Deals

None Vul

♠ A
 ♥ J 10 8 4
 ♦ Q 10 7 5
 ♣ K Q 6 5

♠ K Q 5

♥ A K 6

♦ A K 9 2

♣ A 10 8



♠ J 10 8 2

♥ Q 5 3

♦ 8 6 4

♣ J 9 4

♠ 9 7 6 4 3

♥ 9 7 2

♦ J 3

♣ 7 3 2

With only 4 points you make a Negative 2♦ response to partner's 2♣ opener. He now bids 2NT. What is your bid?

True, 4 points isn't much. But added to partner's 22-24 it becomes enough for a game. Your problem isn't whether to bid to the game or not, (you definitely will), but whether you should use Stayman to find out if there is a 4-4 ♠ fit. You decide not to do this because your 4-3-3-3 distribution removes the possibility of you getting any ruffs. So you bid 3NT.

West	North	East	South
	2♣	Pass	2♦
Pass	2NT	Pass	3NT
All Pass			
3NT by North			

Board 4

East Deals

Both Vul

♠ K 8 7 3
 ♥ 9 2
 ♦ J 8 7 4 2
 ♣ 10 3

♠ A J 10 9 2

♥ 10 7

♦ Q 3

♣ K 9 7 2

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W		E
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♠ -

♥ A K Q J 8 6 4 3

♦ A 5

♣ Q J 4

♠ Q 6 5 4

♥ 5

♦ K 10 9 6

♣ A 8 6 5

West	North	East	South
		2♣	Pass
2♦	Pass	2♥	Pass
2NT	Pass	4♥	
All Pass			
4♥ by East			

You dealt this hand.

You only have 20 points, but you have 9 playing tricks. You have two choices, open 4♥ or open 2♣. Usually 4♥ would show a slightly weaker hand than this, so you bid 2♣. Partner responds 2♦.

Of course you bid your 8-card suit. But no jumping, just bid 2♥. Partner now says 2NT.

Partner has between 3 and 7 points. Somewhere in those points might be the one trick you need, but you don't have any scientific way of finding out. So just bid 4♥ and hope. (There it is, the ♣10.)